

mtg-liquidity-signal: the Current Liquidity index

Snapshot 2026-07-27. By Cameraderie Cards. Informational only, not financial advice.

Every existing model in this toolkit tells you *direction*: will a card rise (buy), has it peaked (sell), is it about to be reprinted (brace). None of them tells you whether you can actually **exit**. A perfect sell call is worthless on a card that takes months to move and only at a deep discount. This model fills that gap. It assigns every Magic: The Gathering card a **Current Liquidity** score from 0 to 100: how easily an owner could turn it into cash right now.

What goes into the score

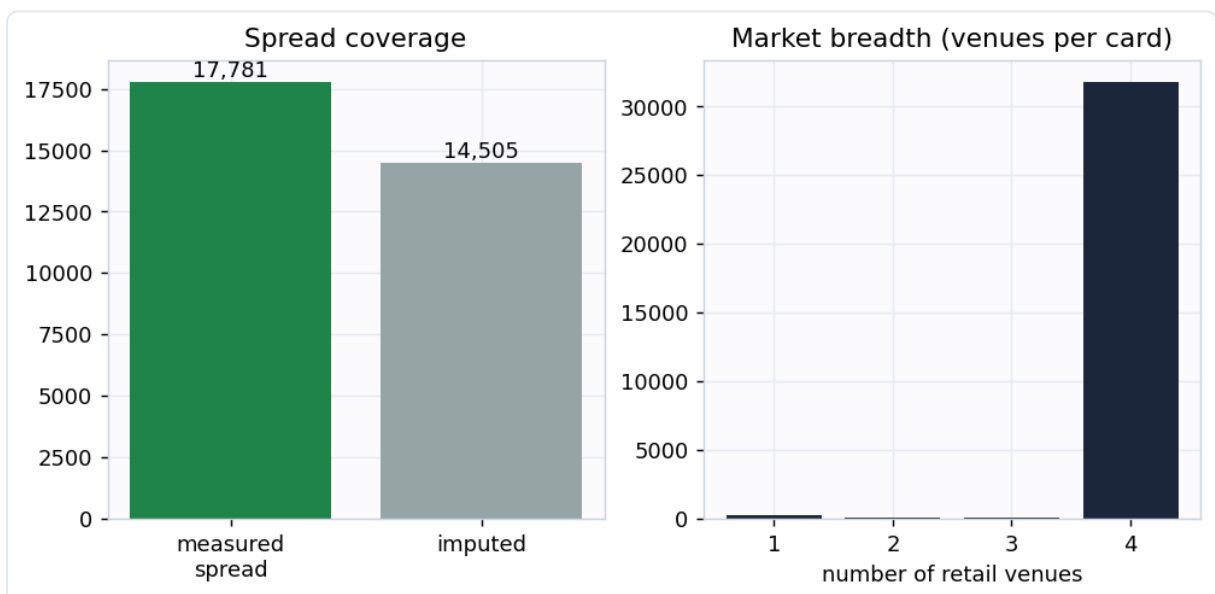
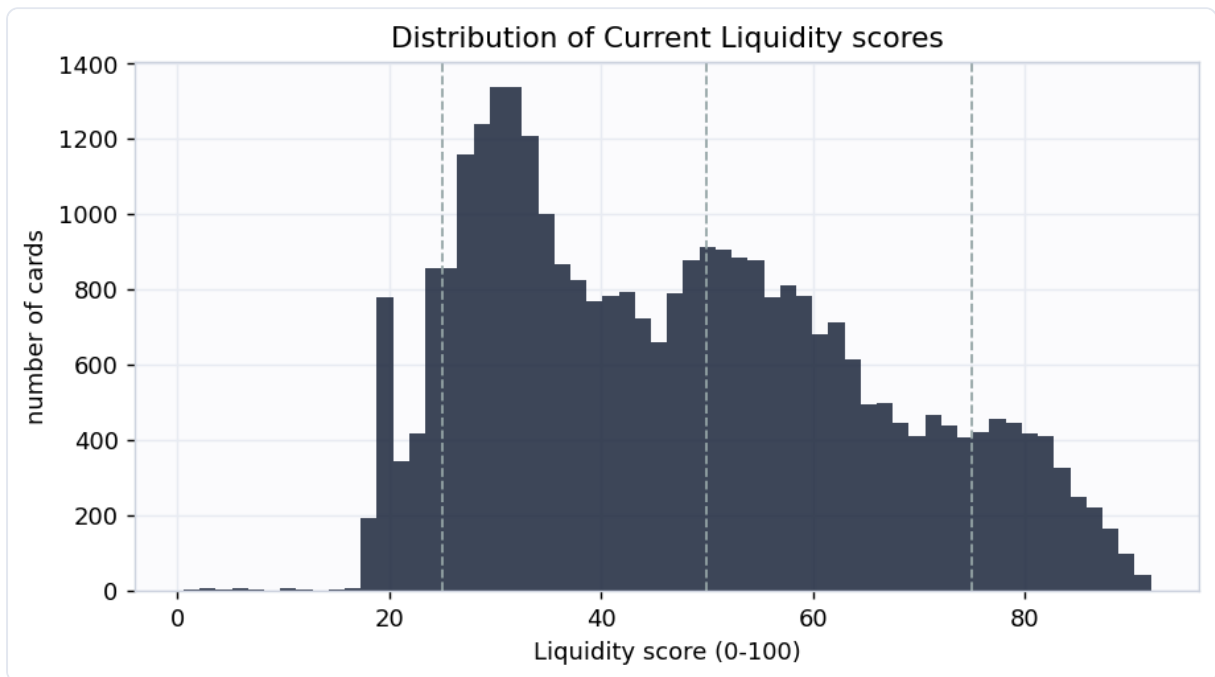
Liquidity is built from four measurable proxies, each normalized to a percentile and blended (weights {'spread': 0.4, 'depth': 0.25, 'activity': 0.2, 'demand': 0.15}):

Component	What it measures	Source
Spread	bid-ask cost to round-trip, CardKingdom buylist vs retail on the same printing	multi-venue price feed
Depth	how many venues list the card, whether a dealer will buy it, cross-venue price agreement	multi-venue price feed
Activity	how often the quoted price actually moves over 120 days (a flat price means nothing is trading)	16-year daily history
Demand	Commander-format popularity (EDHREC)	EDHREC

A card scores high only when it is cheap to exit, sold in many places, actively repricing, and wanted. The weights lean on the spread because that is the cost an owner actually pays to sell.

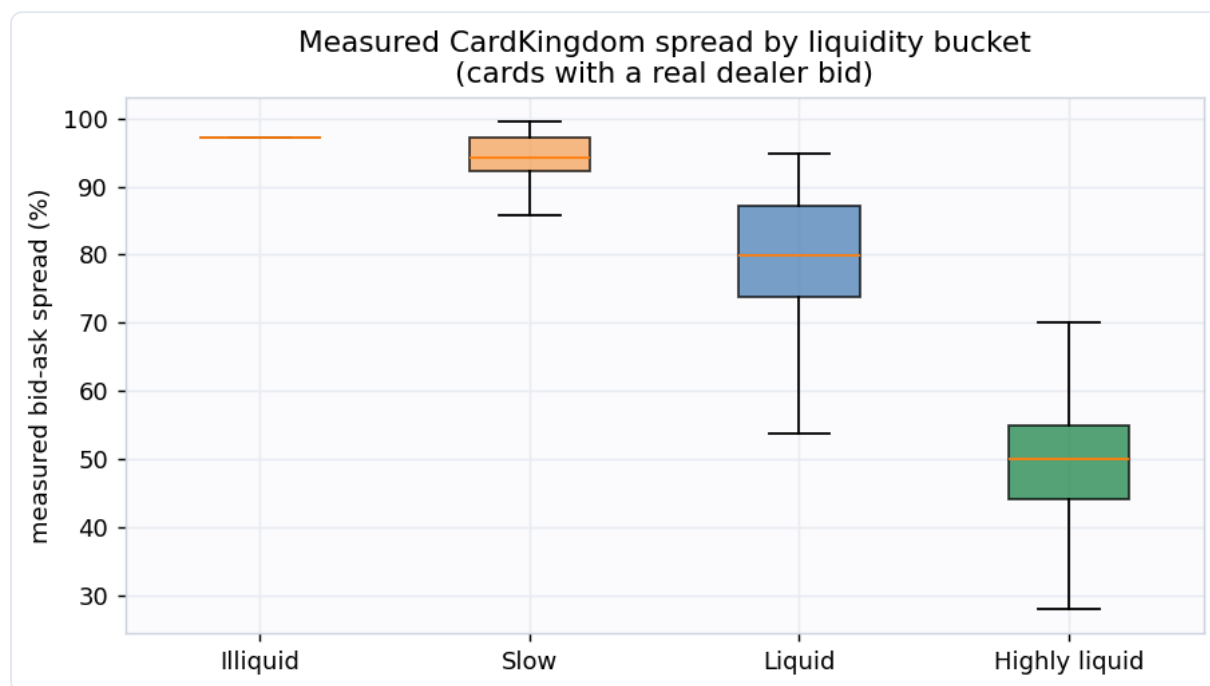
Coverage

Scored **32,286 cards** at this snapshot. **17,781** of them have a real dealer bid (CardKingdom buylist), so their spread is **measured**, not estimated; the median measured spread is **87.0%**. Cards without a dealer bid are flagged `is_imputed` and scored from depth, activity, and demand only.

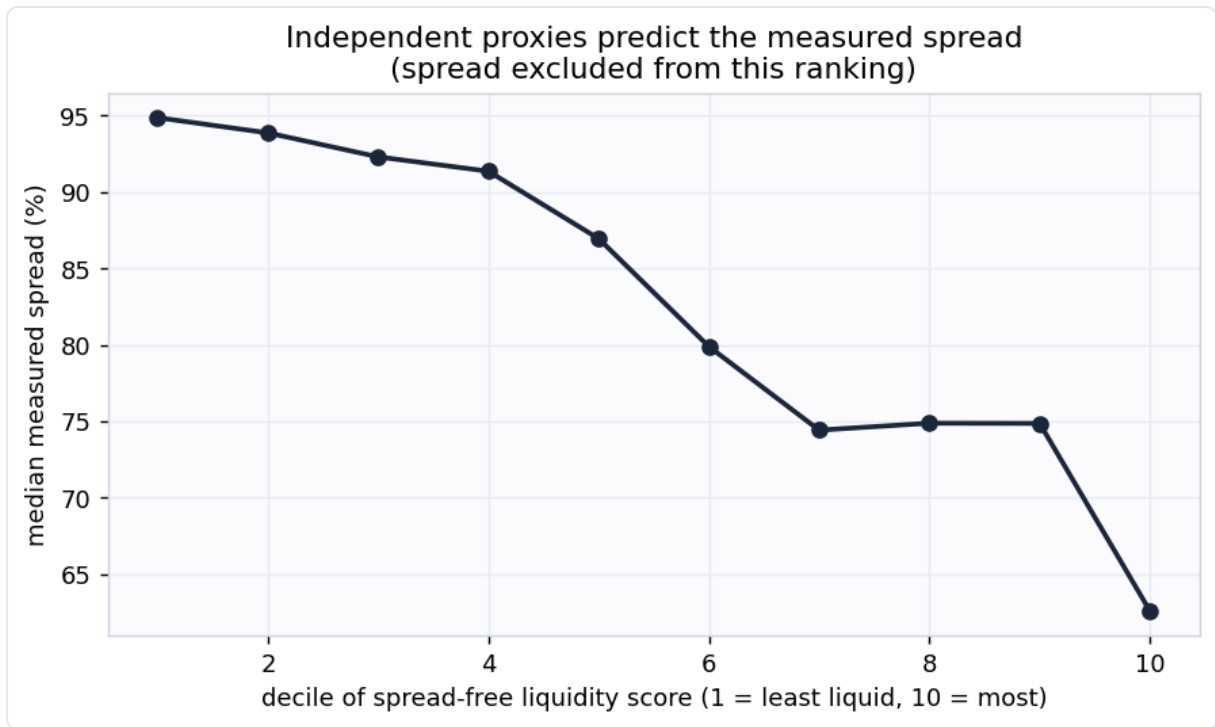


Does the score mean anything? Two honest checks

1. Measured spread lines up with the buckets. Cards the index calls illiquid really do cost more to round-trip. Because the spread is one input to the score, this is partly a consistency check rather than a clean test.



2. Independent proxies predict the spread (the real test). If we rank cards using *only* depth, activity, and demand and deliberately **exclude the spread**, the measured spread still falls steadily as that spread-free score rises (rank correlation **0.466**). The proxies that never saw the spread agree with the spread. That is genuine corroboration, not circular reasoning.



Example cards

Example cards (snapshot 2026-07-27)

	Frantic Search score 92 spread 39%	Counterspell score 92 spread 40%	Berserk score 92 spread 34%	Stomping Ground score 92 spread 37%	Flooded Strand score 92 spread 33%
Most liquid	Instant Draw two cards, then discard two cards. Untap up to three lands. <i>In the skies of the Si-Wing Desert, a solitary winged lemur searched in vain for a lost friend.</i>	Instant Counter target spell.	Instant Cast Berserk only before the combat damage step. Target creature gains trample and gets +X/+0 until end of turn, where X is its power. At the beginning of the next end step, destroy that creature if it attacked this turn.	Land — Mountain Forest • Add • to •. As this land enters, you may pay 2 life. If you don't, it enters tapped. "Nara's active mantle and energetic water cycle create staggeringly beautiful rock formations and a variety of tropical microclimates. Don't feed the midgets!" —Lavemim Galactopodius	Land • Pay 1 life, Sacrifice Flooded Strand: Search your library for a Plains or Island card, put it onto the battlefield, then shuffle. Once a prosperous Vintress brews, note might claim and reclaimed by the waters of the tides.
Least liquid (> \$5)	Planeswalker — Bolas Each opponent loses 3 life unless that player sacrifices a nontap permanent or discards a card. • Destroy target creature. Draw a card. Nicol Bolas, the Deceiver deals 7 damage to each opponent. You draw seven cards.	Artifact Creature — Cyberman Artifact creatures you control have afflict 3. (Whenever a creature with afflict 3 becomes blocked, defending player loses 3 life.) "Obey or you will be destroyed."	Legendary Enchantment Creature — Human Druid Confusion — Whenever Calix, Guided by Fate or another enchantment covers the battlefield under your control, put a +1/+1 counter on target creature. Whenever Calix or an enchanted creature you control deals combat damage to a player, you may create a token that's a copy of a nongendered enchantment you control. Do this only once each turn.	Legendary Creature — Human Noble Warrior Horsemanship, haste "Dong Zhao's man, Lu Bu, warrior without peer, far surpassed the champions of his genre." Blas, Gao Jiansheng	Creature — Human Warlock When Witch Enchanter enters the battlefield, destroy target artifact or enchantment an opponent controls. Shilongar's famine once starved Stosnia into embracing vampirism. The Deceiver's Green could not let the same happen to Kozilek.

The most liquid cards are heavily played eternal and Commander staples that sell in minutes at a known price. The least liquid expensive cards are thin-market oddities: no dealer will quote a buy price, and they list in only one or two places.

Buckets

Bucket	Score	Cards	Median measured spread
Highly liquid	75-100	3,285	50.0%
Liquid	50-75	10,692	79.9%
Slow	25-50	15,633	94.3%
Illiquid	0-25	2,676	97.1%

How this plugs into the other signals

Liquidity is a multiplier on every other call. It converts "should I sell" into "can I sell, how fast, at what cost," and it filters out illiquid buy candidates the spike model would otherwise flag. In the toolkit's risk-adjusted value equation, the expected value of a position is discounted by its spread and expected time-to-sale to get a **net realizable** value.

Honest limitations

- This is **version 1: a composite proxy index, not a supervised forecast**. It does not carry a held-out AUC because there is no public ground-truth label for "days to sale."
- There is **no true traded-volume or listing-count data yet**. Spread, price staleness, and venue breadth are stand-ins for depth and velocity. The roadmap adds TCGplayer listing counts and sales velocity (the printing table already carries the join key), which will replace the proxies with measured depth.
- Buylist coverage is CardKingdom-only and United States centric. Cards without a CardKingdom bid have an imputed spread and should be read with that caveat.
- Informational only, not financial advice.

Generated by `scripts/build_report.py` from `data/processed/liquidity_features.parquet`.